

HS 203: Understanding Society

Course Code	HS 203
Course Name	Understanding Society
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	Consent of the faculty member
Intended for	B.Tech
Distribution	Elective
Approval	2nd Adhoc Senate (May 2012), in the B.Tech HSS core (Humanities and Social Sciences streams) curriculum

Course Contents

Basic Sociological Concepts Society, Community, Social Structure, Function, Status & Role, Power & Authority, Social Groups Primary and Secondary, Socialization and Culture

Classical Sociological Thought and Perspectives Aguste Comte (Positivist)- Emile Durkheim (Functionalist), Karl Marx (Conflict), Max Weber (Structural Functionalist)

Historical Concepts and Perspectives Evolution of Indian Society, Historical dimensions of Caste, Class, Religion and Gender, Changes and Continuities in Indian Society

Psychological Concepts and Perspectives Introduction: Nature and scope of social psychology. Groups: Structure, functions and effects; social facilitation, social loafing and social conformity, Communication: Verbal and nonverbal processes; language and social interaction; barriers to communication, Social perception: Impression formation, role of non-verbal cues; attribution process; theories of Kelly and Weiner, Attitudes: Formation, measurement and change. Prejudice and discrimination: Sources and dynamics; techniques of overcoming prejudice, Pro-social behavior: Cooperation and helping behavior; personal, situational and socio-cultural determinants of helping.

Recommended Reading List

1. Alex Inkeles., What is Sociology?: an Introduction to the Discipline and Profession, Prentice-Hall Publishing, 1964.
2. Anthony Giddens., Sociology, 5th Edition, Polity Press, 2006.
3. Michael Haralambos, Sociology: Themes and Perspectives, 7th Edition, Collins Publishing, 2008.
4. Penguin Dictionary of Sociology, 5th Edition, Penguin publishing, 2006.
5. Shankar Rao, Sociology: Principles of Sociology, S. Chand & Company Ltd, 2011.
6. T.B. Bottomore., Sociology: A Guide to Problems and Literature, Routledge Publication, 1962
7. Alcock, J. E., Carment, D. N., Sadava, S. N., Collins, J. E. & Green J. M., A textbook of social psychology, Prentice Hall, 1998.
8. Aronson, E., Wilson, T. D., & Akert, R. M., Social Psychology, 7th Edition, Prentice Hall, 2010.
9. Baron, R. A., & Byrne, D., Social psychology, 8th Edition, Prentice Hall of India, 1998.
10. Taylor, S. E., Peplau, A. L., & Sears, D. O., Social Psychology, 12th Edition, Prentice Hall, 2006.
11. Dumont, L., Homo Hierarchicus, University of Chicago Press, 1980.
12. Ghurye, G.S. 1932. Caste and Race in India. London: K. Paul, Trench, Trubner & Co.